Mephedrone syndicate investigation at Dongri, Mumbai

CASE STUDY - 06

Name of the Drug : Mephedrone

Qty. Seized : 20 Kg Mephedrone

NCB Zonal Unit : Mumbai Zonal Unit

Total Arrest : 06 Persons

Intelligence development

- In response to rapid drug trafficking activity, especially Mephedrone, NCB-Mumbai strengthened its intelligence sources and identified a Dongri, Mumbai-based syndicate. Information led investigators to a kingpin identified in the report as 'X', supported by his wife 'Y' and another person 'Z'.

Seizures and follow-up action

- Based on specific information, an associate was intercepted with 3 kg of Mephedrone in Dongri on 09.06.2023. Follow-up action led to interception of another person with 2 kg of Mephedrone at his premises. A subsequent search at the kingpin's home recovered another 15 kg of Mephedrone, along with cash of Rs. 1,10,24,000/- and gold ornaments weighing 186.6 grams.

Financial investigation

- Financial investigation resulted in freezing multiple properties, including three flats, gold and cash valued at Rs. 4.90 crores. Three bank lockers contained cash, gold and silver worth Rs. 80,80,870/-. Two under-construction flats valued at Rs. 70 lakh were identified for investigation. The report states that drug proceeds were routed through bank accounts and used to purchase property, gold and other valuables.

ORIGINAL SOURCE VISUAL

Original NCB Annual Report 2023 page containing Case Study 06, reproduced from the uploaded source.

CASE STUDY-06

Name of the Drug : Mephedrone **Qty. Seized : 20 Kg Mephedrone**

NCB Zonal Unit : Mumbai Zonal Unit **Total Arrest: 06 Persons**

- In wake of rapid drug trafficking activity, especially Mephedrone, NCB-Mumbai boosted its intelligence sources which led to identification of a Dongri, Mumbai based syndicate. This area is known as hub of organized crime syndicate (Underworld) of country. Gradually, information was deciphered which led to zero down of kingpin named 'X'. He was actively supported by his wife 'Y' and other person 'Z'.
- The specific information was analysed wherein consignment was to be delivered on behest of 'X' to 'A' in Dongri. A team of NCB-Mumbai was established who setup a infallible trap layout in Dongri. Later, based on specific information on 09.06.2023, 'B', a close associate of 'A' was intercepted with 3 kgs Mephedrone in Dongri. Immediate follow up action led to interception of 'A' with 2 kgs Mephedrone from his premise in Dongri, Mumbai. However, subsequent field information was analyzed which indicated huge drug quantity of Mephedrone was stored nearby only.
- Consequently, follow up action was conducted at home of 'X' which led to recovery of another 15 kgs Mephedrone which was closely guarded by his wife 'Y'. Further extended search led to recovery of cash in tune of Rs.1,10,24,000/- and gold ornaments weighing 186.6 gms.
- During financial investigation multiple properties including 03 flats, gold, cash, worth Rs. 4.90 crores were freezed. Further, three more bank lockers were opened and found cash, gold & silver worth Rs 80,80,870/-. Two under construction flats booked by accused worth Rs 70 lakh, were identified and subject to financial investigation. It was found that huge amount of drug proceeds was routed through different bank accounts to launder the money. Thus this laundered money was used for purchase of properties, gold and other valuables.

